

AGGLOMERATE

Composed of relatively large rock fragments set in a finer matrix, agglomerate forms after volcanic explosions.

PITCHSTONE

This dense volcanic rock has variable composition and colour, and a pitch-like, resinous lustre.

PORPHYRITIC TRACHYTE

This rock has a complex mineralogy of alkali feldspars, quartz, micas, pyroxenes, and hornblende. Its fine-grained matrix contains larger crystals.

PORPHYRITIC ANDESITE

Commonly composed of plagioclase feldspars, pyroxenes, and amphiboles, porphyritic andesite contains larger crystals set in its fine-grained matrix.

DACITE

A pale- to medium-coloured rock with very fine grains, dacite is mainly made of plagioclase feldspars and quartz, with pyroxenes, biotite mica, and hornblende.

AMYGDALOIDAL ANDESITE

Brown, grey, purple, or red, this is a fine-grained volcanic rock containing infilled gas bubbles called amygdales.

SPLITE

This fine-grained, brownish volcanic rock contains augite and plagioclase feldspars. It forms by the alteration of basalt lava in contact with sea water.

TRACHYTE

Trachytes are a group of fine-grained volcanic rocks containing alkali feldspars and dark-coloured mafic minerals such as biotite, hornblende, and pyroxenes.

OBSIDIAN

Typically very dark, obsidian is formed by the rapid cooling of highly viscous rhyolitic lava before individual minerals have had time to form crystals. This gives it a glassy texture. Obsidian has been used as a cutting tool since ancient times.

SNOWFLAKE OBSIDIAN

The "snowflakes" in this glassy, black volcanic rock, with a high silica content, are areas of devitrified (crystalline) glass.

RHOMB PORPHYRY

This rock is characterized by large crystals of feldspars with a rhomb-shaped cross-section set in its dark, fine-grained matrix. Unlike all the extrusive rocks on this spread, rhomb porphyry is an intrusive rock – formed from magma underground – like all the rocks on the following spread.